

“…WE HAVE YET MANY MOUNTAINS TO SCALE AND RIVERS TO CROSS AND BOULDERS TO BREAK BEFORE THE VAST TREASURES OF THE INDIAN ARTS CAN BE FULLY EXCAVATED…”

Dancer, scholar, writer

Kapila Vatsyayan was born in British India into an unusual family. Reformist and liberal in their outlook, they were involved in the freedom movement and in the arts. Thus, Vatsyayan’s own exposure to Indian art forms began early: she trained in a number of dance forms, including Kathak, Manipuri and Bharatanatyam, and studied English literature at university. She subsequently won a scholarship that took her to the US. It was here that she learned to combine her practical understanding of Indian art forms with theory and scholarship, and realized the importance of applying a serious academic approach to Indian art.

